

Variables and Measures

Overview

This study uses survey items to measure awareness, usage, satisfaction, perceived usefulness, internship readiness, reasons for non-use, and improvement priorities. Most scale items use a 1–5 Likert scale.

Scale anchors:

1. Strongly disagree
2. Disagree
3. Neutral
4. Agree
5. Strongly agree

Variable Table

Variable	Type	Measurement	Example Survey Item
respondent_id	Identifier	Assigned anonymous number	R001
consent	Binary	Yes/No	Do you agree to participate?
year_of_study	Categorical	2nd, 3rd, 4th year	What is your year of study?
school	Categorical	Computer Science, Management, Mathematics	Which school are you enrolled in?
searched_for_internship	Binary	Yes/No	Have you searched for an internship?
completed_internship	Binary	Yes/No	Have you completed an internship?
awareness_score	Numeric	1–5	I am aware of KIU internship support services.
used_support	Binary	Yes/No (grouping variable)	Have you used KIU internship support services?
support_services_used	Multi-select	Service categories	Which support services have you used?
nonuse_reason	Categorical	Main reason	What is the main reason you have not used support services?
info_availability	Numeric	1–5, users only	Internship information is easy to find.
communication_quality	Numeric	1–5, users only	Internship-related communication is clear and timely.
application_support	Numeric	1–5, users only	KIU provides useful support for internship applications.
cv_support	Numeric	1–5, users only	KIU provides useful CV or resume support.
interview_support	Numeric	1–5, users only	KIU provides useful interview preparation support.
industry_connections	Numeric	1–5, users only	KIU provides helpful employer or industry connections.
accessibility	Numeric	1–5, users only	Internship support services are easy to access.
overall_satisfaction	Numeric	1–5, users only	Overall, I am satisfied with KIU internship support services.
support_readiness_impact	Numeric	1–5, users only (analysed separately)	KIU support has improved my internship readiness.

Variable	Type	Measurement	Example Survey Item
finding_confidence	Numeric	1–5	I feel confident finding internship opportunities.
cv_confidence	Numeric	1–5	I feel confident preparing a strong CV.
interview_confidence	Numeric	1–5	I feel confident preparing for internship interviews.
employer_expectations	Numeric	1–5	I understand what employers expect from interns.
top_improvement_priority	Categorical	Priority choice	Which improvement would help students the most?
biggest_weaknesses	Text	Open-ended	What is the biggest weakness of KIU internship support?
improvement_suggestion	Text	Open-ended	What improvement would you suggest?

Composite Scores

Satisfaction Score

Calculated **only for respondents who used KIU internship support services** (n = 38). It is the mean of eight items:

- info_availability
- communication_quality
- application_support
- cv_support
- interview_support
- industry_connections
- accessibility
- overall_satisfaction

Observed: **M = 2.68**, **SD = 0.56**, **Cronbach's α = .767**

Readiness Score

Calculated for **all consenting respondents** (N = 122). It is the mean of four items:

- finding_confidence
- cv_confidence
- interview_confidence
- employer_expectations

Observed: **M = 2.89, SD = 0.85, Cronbach's α = .771**

This is the study's **primary outcome variable** and the basis for the Welch t-test comparing users and non-users.

Why **support_readiness_impact** Is Excluded

The item **support_readiness_impact** is analysed separately and is **not** part of **readiness_score**. It asks support users whether KIU services *improved* their readiness — a subjective attribution of benefit — rather than measuring a general readiness level. It also applies only to support users, so including it would make the composite non-comparable across groups. Observed among users: M = 2.95, SD = 0.93.

Notes for Interpretation

A higher score means a more positive perception. A readiness score close to 5 indicates that a student feels highly prepared for the internship search and application process.

Because the study uses a **cross-sectional convenience sample**, differences between users and non-users must be interpreted as **associations**, not as proof that support services caused higher readiness. Self-selection is a plausible alternative explanation: more proactive or confident students may be more likely both to seek out services and to feel ready.